

mise based on how that particular engine displays results for searches in your particular category.

The similarities: One SEO strategy to rule them all

Outside of these differences however, it must be noted that indexing on search terms and the techniques that are used to optimise a page for search engines are more or less the same across search engines. Factors that lead to adequate optimization on Google are quite likely to produce satisfactory optimization on Yahoo or Bing with a few minor tweaks. They all depend heavily on the metadata of the page to index and display results and optimising this aspect will lead to good results. There are no different strategies as such for optimising different search engines because of these similarities across the search engines which are quite similar. Also, search engines often have alliances and vastly similar algorithms which makes it possible to simultaneously optimise across different search engines. Yahoo for example, has a tie up with Bing making all Yahoo based web searches identical to Bing based ones. The only differences lie in the advertising strategies and layouts of the two search engines while displaying results, something that need not concern us while we try to optimise our webpages for these search engines.

The differences vary based on the target audience you would like to impact. They may tend to use different search engines by default which results in minor tweaks to SEO strategies. It's important to remember that search engines have close relationships with products and browsers. Google Chrome users tend to use Google as their default search engine whereas Internet Explorer users favour Bing. Moreover, android phones often have Google Chrome as a preloaded app which mobile phone users tend to prefer. Therefore, based on your audience, the type of search engine used varies.

Tweaking for Bing

There are very few changes that one needs to make to their SEO strategy depending on the search engine. The theme here seems to be that Bing prefers local search results more favourably than Google, which is more concerned with overall popularity. The key differences in the way these two search engines understand search queries are

Queries with multiple interpretations: Bing displays local results first in such cases. Google displays the most popular website for such a query